HTML ELEMENTS

THE VISUAL CHEAT SHEET

A beginner-friendly guide to what HTML tags do, how to write them, and what a browser typically displays.

WHAT'S INSIDE
- Document structure and page sections
- Text, links, lists, tables and forms
- Images, audio, video, SVG and embedded content
- Interactive elements and web components
- Obsolete/historical tags clearly marked

Each entry includes: definition • real code example • expected browser result

How to use this PDF

Use the companion HTML file for searchable filters and live browser-style previews. This PDF is designed for reading, printing, and revision. Browser output can vary with CSS, browser settings, and the resources a page loads.

Important: Obsolete elements are included for historical completeness, not as recommendations. Prefer current semantic HTML and CSS for new projects.

Reference links: WHATWG HTML Living Standard · MDN HTML elements

Quick contents

- Document setup — 13 entries
- Page sections — 14 entries
- Text blocks — 15 entries
- Inline text meaning — 28 entries
- Edits — 2 entries
- Images and media — 13 entries
- Tables — 10 entries
- Forms — 14 entries
- Interactive — 4 entries
- Web components — 1 entries
- Ruby / legacy — 1 entries
- Obsolete historical tags — 28 entries

Core syntax

An element often has an opening tag, content, and a closing tag: `<p>Hello</p>`. Void elements such as `<img>`, `<br>`, `<input>`, and `<meta>` do not wrap content. Attributes such as `href`, `src`, `alt`, and `class` configure an element.

Document setup

<html> CURRENT

The root element wrapping the whole HTML document. Set the document language with lang.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<html lang="en"> ... </html>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not visible by itself; defines the document.

<head> CURRENT

Contains document metadata, styles, scripts, title, and linked resources.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<head><title>My page</title></head>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not shown in the page body; title appears in the browser tab.

<body> CURRENT

Contains the webpage's visible content and interactive elements.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<body><h1>Hello</h1></body>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A large heading: Hello.

<title> CURRENT

Sets the document title shown in the browser tab and bookmarks.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<title>My website</title>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not in the page body; shown in the browser tab.

<base> CURRENT

Sets the base URL used to resolve relative URLs, and optionally a default link target.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<base href="https://example.com/">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Invisible; changes how relative URLs are resolved.

<link> CURRENT

Links an external resource, commonly a stylesheet or site icon.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Invisible itself; linked CSS can style the page.

<meta> CURRENT

Provides metadata such as character encoding, viewport, and description.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Invisible metadata that can affect mobile layout and search snippets.

<style> CURRENT

Embeds CSS rules in the document.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<style>p { color: teal; }</style>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: The tag itself is invisible; paragraphs become teal.

<script> CURRENT

Embeds or links JavaScript.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<script>console.log('Hello');</script>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Usually no visible output unless the script changes the page.

<noscript> CURRENT

Provides fallback content when scripting is disabled or unsupported.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<noscript>Please enable JavaScript.</noscript>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Fallback text appears only when scripting is disabled/unsupported.

<template> CURRENT

Stores HTML that is not rendered until script clones or uses it.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<template id="card"><article>A card</article></template>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Nothing visible until JavaScript uses the template.

<slot> CURRENT

Placeholder in a web component's shadow tree where provided content can be inserted.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<slot name="title">Default title</slot>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Meaningful in a custom element's shadow DOM; otherwise not a normal page feature.

<doctype> CURRENT

A declaration, not an element. Tells browsers to use standards mode.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<!doctype html>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not displayed. Put it at the top of the file.

Page sections

<header> CURRENT

Introductory content for a page or section, such as a logo or heading.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<header><h1>My site</h1></header>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A header area containing “My site”.

<nav> CURRENT

A section containing major navigation links.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<nav><a href="#home">Home</a> <a href="#about">About</a></nav>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Clickable Home and About links.

<main> CURRENT

The dominant, unique content of the page. Normally one visible main element per page.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<main><h1>Products</h1><p>Our catalog.</p></main>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Products heading and “Our catalog.”

<section> CURRENT

Groups related content into a thematic section, usually with a heading.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<section><h2>About</h2><p>Our story.</p></section>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: About heading followed by Our story.

<article> CURRENT

Self-contained content that could stand alone, such as a post, news story, or comment.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<article><h2>News</h2><p>New store opens.</p></article>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A News heading and a short story.

<aside> CURRENT

Related or tangential content, such as a sidebar, note, or related links.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<aside>Related: HTML basics</aside>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A separate related-content block.

<footer> CURRENT

Footer for a page or section, often containing copyright or related links.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<footer>© 2026 Example</footer>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: © 2026 Example at the bottom of a section/page.

<address> CURRENT

Contact information for the nearest article or page owner.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<address>hello@example.com</address>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Contact information, usually italicized.

<h1> CURRENT

Top-level heading, typically the main page title.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<h1>Big heading</h1>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Very large, bold heading.

<h2> CURRENT

Second-level heading for a subsection.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<h2>Section heading</h2>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Large bold heading, smaller than h1.

<h3> CURRENT

Third-level heading for a subsection.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<h3>Subsection</h3>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Medium bold heading.

<h4> CURRENT

Fourth-level heading.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<h4>Smaller heading</h4>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Smaller bold heading.

<h5> CURRENT

Fifth-level heading.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<h5>Small heading</h5>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Small bold heading.

<h6> CURRENT

Sixth-level and lowest heading level.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<h6>Smallest heading</h6>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Smallest default heading, still bold.

Text blocks

<p> CURRENT

A paragraph of text.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<p>This is a paragraph.</p>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: This is a paragraph, with spacing around it.

CURRENT

Generic block container with no built-in semantic meaning; useful for grouping and styling.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<div class="notice">Important message</div>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A block containing Important message; styling depends on CSS.

 CURRENT

Creates a line break inside text. Do not use it for large layout spacing.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
First line<br>Second line
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: First line, then Second line below it.

<hr> CURRENT

Thematic break between paragraphs or sections, often rendered as a horizontal rule.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<p>Before</p><hr><p>After</p>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Before, a horizontal line, then After.

<pre> CURRENT

Preformatted text; preserves spaces and line breaks.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<pre>one two
three</pre>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Monospaced text preserving spaces and the second line.

<blockquote> CURRENT

A block quotation from another source.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<blockquote>Learning by doing works.</blockquote>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Indented quotation text.

 CURRENT

Ordered list, usually numbered.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<ol><li>First</li><li>Second</li></ol>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: 1. First 2. Second

 CURRENT

Unordered list, usually bulleted.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<ul><li>Apples</li><li>Pears</li></ul>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: • Apples • Pears

 CURRENT

A list item inside ol, ul, or menu.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<ul><li>One item</li></ul>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A bullet followed by One item.

<dl> CURRENT

Description list pairing terms with descriptions or values.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<dl><dt>HTML</dt><dd>Markup language</dd></dl>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: HTML, with an indented description below.

<dt> CURRENT

A term/name in a description list.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<dl><dt>Browser</dt><dd>Software for websites</dd></dl>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Browser followed by its description.

<dd> CURRENT

A description/value associated with a term in a description list.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<dl><dt>HTML</dt><dd>Markup language</dd></dl>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Indented text: Markup language.

<figure> CURRENT

Self-contained media or content, optionally with a caption.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<figure><img src="photo.jpg" alt="Mountain"><figcaption>A mountain</figcaption></figure>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: An image, with a caption below it.

<figcaption> CURRENT

Caption/legend for a figure element.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<figure><div>■ Chart</div><figcaption>Sales by month</figcaption></figure>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Chart illustration with “Sales by month” below.

<menu> CURRENT

A list of commands or menu items; often displayed like a list.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<menu><li>Save</li><li>Print</li></menu>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A list with Save and Print.

Inline text meaning

<a> CURRENT

Creates a hyperlink to a page, file, email address, or in-page location.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<a href="https://example.com">Visit Example</a>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Blue/purple clickable Visit Example link (theme-dependent).

CURRENT

Generic inline container with no meaning by itself.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<p>Price: <span>$12</span></p>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Price: $12 on the same line.

CURRENT

Marks stress emphasis; browsers usually italicize it.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<p>I <em>really</em> mean it.</p>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: “really” is italicized.

CURRENT

Marks strong importance or urgency; browsers usually bold it.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<strong>Warning!</strong>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Bold Warning! text.

<small> CURRENT

Fine print or side comments, such as disclaimers.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<small>Terms apply.</small>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Smaller Terms apply. text.

<s> CURRENT

Marks information that is no longer accurate/relevant, not a deletion edit.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<s>Was $30</s> Now $20
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Was $30 crossed out; Now $20 remains.

<cite> CURRENT

Marks the title of a creative work, such as a book or film.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<cite>Things Fall Apart</cite>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Title typically appears italicized.

<q> CURRENT

Inline quotation; browsers may add quotation marks.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<q>Keep learning</q>, she said.
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: “Keep learning”, she said.

<dfn> CURRENT

Marks the term being defined in the surrounding text.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<p><dfn>HTML</dfn> structures web content.</p>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: HTML is marked as the term being defined.

<abbr> CURRENT

Marks an abbreviation or acronym; title can provide expansion.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<abbr title="HyperText Markup Language">HTML</abbr>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: HTML; hovering may show its expansion.

<data> CURRENT

Pairs visible content with a machine-readable value.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<data value="sku-42">Blue mug</data>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Blue mug; machine-readable value is sku-42.

<time> CURRENT

Represents a date, time, or duration; datetime gives a machine-readable value.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<time datetime="2026-10-12">October 12, 2026</time>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: October 12, 2026.

<code> CURRENT

Marks a fragment of computer code.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
Use <code>console.log()</code> to log.
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: console.log() appears in monospace.

<var> CURRENT

Represents a variable in a mathematical/programming expression.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<p><var>x</var> = 3</p>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: x is typically italicized, followed by = 3.

<samp> CURRENT

Represents sample output from a computer program.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<samp>File saved.</samp>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: File saved. in a monospace font.

<kbd> CURRENT

Represents user input, often keyboard input.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
Press <kbd>Ctrl</kbd> + <kbd>S</kbd>.
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Ctrl + S, styled like keyboard input by some browsers.

<sub> CURRENT

Displays subscript text, lower and smaller than surrounding text.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
H<sub>2</sub>O
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: H■O.

<sup> CURRENT

Displays superscript text, higher and smaller than surrounding text.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
x<sup>2</sup>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: x².

<i> CURRENT

Marks text in a different voice/mood or a technical term; not merely a styling tag.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
The <i>in vitro</i> test worked.
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: in vitro appears italicized.

<b> CURRENT

Draws attention to text without adding semantic importance.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
New: <b>limited edition</b>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: limited edition appears bold.

<u> CURRENT

Marks a non-textual annotation; often underlined. Avoid using it just for decoration.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<u>Misspelled</u> word
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Misspelled is underlined.

<mark> CURRENT

Highlights text relevant to the current context.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
Search result: <mark>HTML</mark>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: HTML is highlighted, often yellow.

<bdi> CURRENT

Isolates text whose direction may differ from surrounding text.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
User: <bdi>■■■</bdi>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: User name is direction-isolated for bidirectional text.

<bdo> CURRENT

Overrides text direction using the dir attribute.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<bdo dir="rtl">ABC 123</bdo>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Text direction is forced right-to-left.

<ruby> CURRENT

Container for ruby annotations, often pronunciation hints.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<ruby>■ <rt>■■</rt></ruby>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: ■ with a small pronunciation annotation.

<rt> CURRENT

Ruby annotation text, such as pronunciation.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<ruby>■<rt>■■</rt></ruby>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Small annotation beside/above the base text.

<rp> CURRENT

Fallback parentheses for browsers that do not support ruby annotations.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<ruby>■<rp>(</rp><rt>kan</rt><rp>)</rp></ruby>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Ruby annotation in supported browsers; parentheses are fallback.

<wbr> CURRENT

Marks an optional line-break opportunity in a long word or URL.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
superlongword<wbr>continued
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Usually invisible; allows a line to wrap at that point.

Edits

<ins> CURRENT

Marks content inserted into a document; often underlined by default.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<ins>New wording</ins>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: New wording is typically underlined.

<del> CURRENT

Marks content deleted from a document; often struck through.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<del>Old wording</del>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Old wording is typically crossed out.

Images and media

<img> CURRENT

Embeds an image. Use alt text that conveys its meaning.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<img src="https://placehold.co/220x90" alt="Blue sample banner">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A blue sample banner image. Replace the URL with your own image.

<picture> CURRENT

Offers different image sources for responsive or format-specific images.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<picture><source media="(min-width: 700px)" srcset="wide.jpg"><img src="small.jpg"
alt="Landscape"></picture>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Browser selects a suitable source; fallback img is required.

<source> CURRENT

Provides a media source for picture, audio, or video.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<video controls><source src="movie.mp4" type="video/mp4"></video>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No standalone display; inside video it supplies playable media.

<audio> CURRENT

Embeds audio with optional playback controls.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<audio controls src="sound.mp3">Audio unsupported</audio>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Audio player controls; actual sound requires a valid audio file.

<video> CURRENT

Embeds video with optional playback controls, poster, and dimensions.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<video controls width="240" poster="poster.jpg" src="movie.mp4">Video unsupported</video>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Video player; playable media requires a valid file.

<track> CURRENT

Adds timed text tracks, such as subtitles or captions, to audio/video.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<video controls><track kind="captions" src="captions.vtt" srclang="en" label="English"></video>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No standalone display; captions appear when a valid track is selected.

<map> CURRENT

Defines a clickable image map with one or more hotspots.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<img src="map.png" usemap="#demo" alt="Map"><map name="demo"><area shape="rect" coords="0,0,80,50"
href="#north" alt="North"></map>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Image regions can be clickable; requires a matching image and coordinates.

<area> CURRENT

Defines a clickable hotspot within a map element.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<area shape="circle" coords="50,50,25" href="#info" alt="Info">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Invisible itself; creates a clickable region on its image map.

<iframe> CURRENT

Embeds another webpage or document inside the current page.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<iframe title="Example" src="https://example.com" width="260" height="100"></iframe>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A framed embedded page; some sites block embedding.

<embed> CURRENT

Embeds external content, often plugin-style content or a resource handled by the browser.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<embed src="document.pdf" type="application/pdf" width="220" height="100">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May show a built-in PDF viewer or other supported content.

<object> CURRENT

Represents an external resource, potentially with fallback content.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<object data="document.pdf" type="application/pdf" width="220" height="100">PDF file</object>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May show embedded PDF content, depending on browser.

<canvas> CURRENT

A scriptable bitmap drawing surface; JavaScript draws pixels/shapes.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<canvas width="180" height="60">Canvas fallback</canvas>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Blank rectangle unless JavaScript draws on it.

<svg> CURRENT

Embeds scalable vector graphics markup; SVG has its own element vocabulary.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<svg viewBox="0 0 120 45" role="img" aria-label="Blue circle"><circle cx="22" cy="22" r="16"
fill="royalblue"/><rect x="50" y="8" width="55" height="28" rx="5" fill="orange"/></svg>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A blue circle and an orange rounded rectangle.

Tables

<table> CURRENT

Represents tabular data arranged in rows and columns.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><tr><th>Name</th><th>Score</th></tr><tr><td>Ada</td><td>95</td></tr></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A small two-column table with a header and one data row.

<caption> CURRENT

Provides a title/caption for a table.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><caption>Exam results</caption><tr><td>95%</td></tr></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Exam results appears as the table caption.

<thead> CURRENT

Groups a table's header rows.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><thead><tr><th>Name</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Ada</td></tr></tbody></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No unique look by itself; groups header rows semantically.

<tbody> CURRENT

Groups the main data rows of a table.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><tbody><tr><td>Ada</td></tr></tbody></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No special look by itself; groups body rows.

<tfoot> CURRENT

Groups summary/footer rows in a table.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><tfoot><tr><td>Total: 95</td></tr></tfoot></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A summary row at the bottom (position can depend on markup/browser).

<tr> CURRENT

Defines a table row.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><tr><td>Ada</td><td>95</td></tr></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: One row with two cells.

<th> CURRENT

Header cell for a row or column; scope can clarify what it labels.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><tr><th>Name</th><th>Score</th></tr></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Header cells, usually bold and centered.

<td> CURRENT

A regular data cell in a table.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><tr><td>Ada</td><td>95</td></tr></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Cells containing Ada and 95.

<colgroup> CURRENT

Groups columns for styling or structural metadata.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><colgroup><col span="2"></colgroup><tr><td>A</td><td>B</td></tr></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not directly visible; can target columns with CSS.

<col> CURRENT

Specifies properties for one or more table columns inside colgroup.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<table><colgroup><col style="background:#ffe9a8"></colgroup><tr><td>Highlighted</td></tr></table>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: The first column can be highlighted with supported CSS.

Forms

<form> CURRENT

Groups controls and defines where/how submitted form data is sent.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<form action="/signup" method="post"><input name="email"><button>Join</button></form>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: An input field and Join button; submission needs a server endpoint.

<label> CURRENT

Labels a form control; improves usability and accessibility.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<label for="email">Email</label><input id="email" type="email">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Email text beside an input box.

<input> CURRENT

A versatile form control; type chooses text, checkbox, date, file, and many other controls.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<label>Nickname <input type="text" placeholder="Your name"></label>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A single-line text field.

<button> CURRENT

A clickable button; type can be button, submit, or reset.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<button type="button">Click me</button>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A clickable Click me button.

<select> CURRENT

A dropdown control containing option choices.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<select><option>Kenya</option><option>Germany</option></select>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A dropdown showing Kenya by default.

<datalist> CURRENT

Provides suggested values for an input; user can often still type a different value.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<input list="cities" placeholder="Choose a city"><datalist id="cities"><option value="Nairobi"><option
value="Mombasa"></datalist>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: An input with browser-provided suggestions as you type.

<optgroup> CURRENT

Groups related options within a select dropdown.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<select><optgroup label="East Africa"><option>Kenya</option><option>Uganda</option></optgroup></select>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Dropdown options grouped under East Africa.

<option> CURRENT

One selectable choice in select, optgroup, or datalist.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<select><option value="ke">Kenya</option></select>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Kenya appears as a selectable option.

<textarea> CURRENT

Multi-line text input.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<textarea rows="3" placeholder="Write a message"></textarea>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A larger box where users can type multiple lines.

<output> CURRENT

Displays a result calculated by the page or form.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<output>42</output>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: 42, often used for a calculated result.

<progress> CURRENT

Shows progress toward completion of a task.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<progress value="65" max="100">65%</progress>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A progress bar about 65% filled.

<meter> CURRENT

Shows a scalar value within a known range, such as a rating or disk usage.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<meter min="0" max="100" value="72">72/100</meter>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A gauge-like bar showing 72 out of 100.

<fieldset> CURRENT

Groups related form controls, often with a border.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<fieldset><legend>Account</legend><input placeholder="Username"></fieldset>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A bordered group around the account field.

<legend> CURRENT

Caption for a fieldset.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<fieldset><legend>Account details</legend>Username</fieldset>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Account details appears on the fieldset border.

Interactive

<details> CURRENT

Disclosure widget whose contents can be expanded or collapsed.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<details><summary>More info</summary>This is the hidden detail.</details>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A clickable More info summary that expands to show text.

<summary> CURRENT

Visible label for a details disclosure widget.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<details><summary>Click to expand</summary>Extra content</details>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Click to expand is the clickable disclosure heading.

<dialog> CURRENT

Represents a dialog box or modal; JavaScript can open it with show()/showModal().

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<dialog open>This dialog is open.</dialog>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A dialog-like box. The open attribute makes this example visible.

<popover attribute> CURRENT

Not an element: popover is a global HTML attribute that lets an element act as a popover.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<button popovertarget="tip">Show tip</button><div id="tip" popover>A helpful tip</div>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: A browser-managed popover when the button is activated; this is an attribute, not a tag.

Web components

<custom elements> CURRENT

Not one fixed tag. Developers define their own hyphenated element names with JavaScript.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<user-card>Profile content</user-card>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Looks like ordinary content unless JavaScript/CSS defines the custom element.

Ruby / legacy

<param> OBSOLETE

Historically supplied parameters to an object element; obsolete and non-conforming.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<object data="movie.swf"><param name="autoplay" value="false"></object>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No reliable modern visual effect; do not use.

Obsolete historical tags

<acronym> OBSOLETE

Historically marked acronyms; use abbr instead.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<acronym title="World Wide Web">WWW</acronym>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Often looks like ordinary text; obsolete.

<applet> OBSOLETE

Embedded a Java applet; obsolete and unsupported in modern browsers.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<applet code="Demo.class">Applet</applet>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Does not run as a modern Java applet.

<basefont> OBSOLETE

Set a default font size/color/face for a page; obsolete. Use CSS.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<basefont size="4">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No modern dependable effect.

<big> OBSOLETE

Made text bigger; obsolete. Use CSS font-size.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<big>Bigger text</big>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May render larger in some browsers, but obsolete.

<blink> OBSOLETE

Made text blink in old browsers; obsolete and poor for accessibility.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<blink>Look here!</blink>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Modern browsers generally do not blink it.

OBSOLETE

Centered content; obsolete. Use CSS text-align or layout.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<center>Centered text</center>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May center in some browsers, but do not use.

<dir> OBSOLETE

Directory list element; obsolete. Use ul.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<dir><li>File</li></dir>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Often resembles a list; obsolete.

<font> OBSOLETE

Set font face, size, or color; obsolete. Use CSS.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<font color="red">Red text</font>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May show red text in some browsers; obsolete.

<frame> OBSOLETE

Defined a frame in a frameset; obsolete.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<frame src="page.html">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not valid in modern HTML documents.

<frameset> OBSOLETE

Contained frames instead of a body; obsolete.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<frameset cols="50%,50%">...</frameset>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not valid in modern HTML documents.

<noframes> OBSOLETE

Fallback for browsers without frame support; obsolete.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<noframes>Your browser does not support frames.</noframes>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Obsolete; use normal page content instead.

<isindex> OBSOLETE

Old single-field search prompt; obsolete.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<isindex prompt="Search">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No modern dependable effect.

<keygen> OBSOLETE

Generated key pairs in a form; obsolete and removed from modern standards.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<keygen name="key">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Unsupported in modern browsers.

<listing> OBSOLETE

Displayed preformatted text; obsolete. Use pre and code.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<listing>Example code</listing>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Legacy preformatted display; do not use.

<marquee> OBSOLETE

Scrolling text/image; obsolete and non-standard.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<marquee>Scrolling text</marquee>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Some browsers may scroll the text; avoid it.

<menuitem> OBSOLETE

Old context-menu command element; obsolete and not broadly supported.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<menuitem label="Save">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No dependable modern rendering.

<multicol> OBSOLETE

Experimental/old multi-column text container; non-standard.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<multicol cols="2">Text</multicol>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No dependable modern behavior; use CSS columns.

<nextid> OBSOLETE

Old identifier-generation aid; obsolete.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<nextid n="z1">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No visible effect.

<nobr> OBSOLETE

Prevented text wrapping; non-standard/obsolete. Use CSS white-space: nowrap.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<nobr>Do not wrap this phrase</nobr>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May stay on one line in some browsers; use CSS instead.

<noembed> OBSOLETE

Fallback for browsers without embed support; obsolete.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<noembed>Cannot show embedded content.</noembed>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Not a reliable modern fallback; use normal fallback content.

<plaintext> OBSOLETE

Treated following content as plain text; obsolete and can disrupt parsing.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<plaintext>Text only
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Legacy behavior may display remaining source as text; do not use.

<spacer> OBSOLETE

Inserted blank space in old browsers; non-standard.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<spacer type="horizontal" size="20">
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No dependable modern effect; use CSS margin/padding.

<strike> OBSOLETE

Strikethrough text; obsolete. Use s or del depending on meaning.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<strike>Old price</strike>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May strike text through; obsolete.

<tt> OBSOLETE

Teletype/monospace text; obsolete. Use code or CSS.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<tt>monospace</tt>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: May render monospace in some browsers; obsolete.

<xmp> OBSOLETE

Displayed raw text without parsing markup; obsolete. Use pre/code and escape angle brackets.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<xmp><p>Not parsed</p></xmp>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: Legacy raw-text behavior; do not use.

<content> OBSOLETE

Early Web Components draft element; not standard in modern HTML.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<content select=".title"></content>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No standard behavior; use slot in web components.

<element> OBSOLETE

Early Web Components draft element; not standard in modern HTML.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<element name="my-widget">...</element>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No standard behavior; define custom elements with JavaScript.

<shadow> OBSOLETE

Early Web Components draft element; not standard in modern HTML.

EXAMPLE CODE

```
<shadow></shadow>
```

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Browser view: No standard behavior in modern HTML.

Final reminders

• **Choose meaning first.** Use `nav` for navigation, `main` for primary content, and `button` for actions.

• **Images need useful alt text.** Describe the information an image contributes; use empty alt text for purely decorative images.

• **Forms need labels.** A placeholder is not a replacement for a proper label.

• **HTML alone is not the whole design.** CSS controls colors, spacing, typography and layout; JavaScript adds behavior.

• **Historical tags:** do not use obsolete tags like `font`, `center`, `marquee`, or `frameset` in new work.

Authoritative resources

WHATWG: https://html.spec.whatwg.org/multipage/
MDN: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTML/Element